Abdullah Al Zahid

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Human Resources
Community Growth and Economic Development Department
Regional Municipality of Durham, Whitby, ON

Re: Senior Planner (Job ID 24244)

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Planner position, and in particular for the opening in the Transportation Planning section. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, and before that I was a Transportation Planner at Metrolinx. I hold a master's degree in Transportation Engineering.

The posting puts weight on transportation and growth monitoring, planning data, and the technology behind it. At the City I analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to work out where capacity is short and what that means for future investment. I built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which combined the 2006, 2011 and 2016 surveys into one validated source the division reports from, and I build and maintain the road and right-of-way datasets the division depends on, using GIS and Python.

I also review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them against City standards and Official Plan policy, run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, and present to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions. At Metrolinx I ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services. I also set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. My degrees are in civil and transportation engineering rather than planning or geography, and I am not a member of CIP or OPPI; I would need to confirm whether my experience makes me eligible for the RPP designation. I have not presented evidence at the Ontario Land Tribunal, and my policy work has supported policy staff rather than led the formulation of provincial or regional policy.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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